

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr David Goldberg

Address: 7 Queens Road Belmont Sutton SM2 6BZ

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer objects to the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I am a member of Sutton Bowling Club backing on to the ambulance station site. I object to the planning proposal on several grounds whilst being empathetic to the desire to create the faith based centre for BASMA.

1. The site is completely unsuitable for the proposed use and number of people using it. It is actually quite a small site with only 10 on site car spaces. The plans totally fail to address this issue apart from assuming people will park on road and minimising the impact. As I live in Queens Road where the BASMA use the church for Friday services, I can confirm that on a Friday lunchtime the parking is chaotic, dangerous and illegal in many instances. Visitors park across driveways with little care for blocking drive access or making it dangerous to exit. When considering the ambulance station site - it is even worse as the roads by the site are already used by parents collecting from school. The parking in Balmoral Way, Bowling Way and the adjacent flats will make the junctions very dangerous and line of sight when exiting will be so severely restricted by many cars causing congestion. Having lived with the experience in Queens Road it is foolhardy to think it will be any different. With virtually no parking facilities the visitors will have no choice to park where they can. Because service participation is time sensitive, this increases the pressure on drivers to "dump" their cars where they can to get to the service on time.

2. Impact on Belmont Community. I notice that many comments in support of the plans stress the importance of the development to their community. However, because of the stress caused to residents and other road users it will be the cause of friction within the wider community. The plans are not thought through with regard to the impact on local residents and will become divisive. The site is in the wrong place for such extensive use by so many people causing much inconvenience

to the Belmont wider community.

3. As a member of Sutton Bowling Club we have a car park for members, many of whom are elderly and infirm. On a Friday we are particularly busy as we have several scheduled games and social events. Because of my experience in Queens Road, I fully expect visitors to the BASMA site to abuse our parking facility by parking - thereby making it difficult or impossible for our members to park safely. This will therefor mean that as a club we will have to incur extra cost in preventing unauthorised parking, such as patrols or barriers. I believe it is unreasonable for the BASMA plans to increase our financial burden because of their poor selection of site being unsuitable for their needs.